

Skills

Performing a Disposable Bed Bath

Checklist

Checklist

S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified the health care provider’s orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family, if present.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers; compared identifiers with the information on patient’s identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to the treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Encouraged the patient to void prior to beginning the bath.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient's tolerance for bathing and activity, comfort level, cognitive ability and musculoskeletal function. Assessed for shortness of breath. Before or during the bath, assessed the condition of the patient's skin.	☐	☐	☐	
Arranged all supplies on the overbed table. Positioned a waste container and a laundry hamper close to the patient’s bed.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene and applied clean gloves. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient’s need for isolation precautions or risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Raised the bed to a comfortable working height; lowered the near side rail.	☐	☐	☐	

Placed a bath blanket or towel over the patient. Had him or her hold the top of it. Removed the top sheet from under the bath blanket or towel without exposing the patient. Placed soiled linen in a linen bag.

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Removed the patient's gown or pajamas; used the bath blanket or towel to cover exposed areas of the patient's body.

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1. When the gown had snaps at the sleeves, unsnapped them and removed the gown without pulling on any IV tubing.
2. When an extremity was injured or had reduced mobility, undressed the unaffected side first.
3. When the patient had an IV line and a gown with no snaps, first removed the gown from the arm without the IV line, then removed the gown from the arm with the IV line.
 1. When intravenous fluids were infusing by gravity, unhooked the IV container from the pole and slid the tubing and IV container through the arm of the patient's gown. Rehung the IV container on the pole, checked the intravenous flow rate and regulated it if necessary. Did not disconnect the intravenous tubing to remove the gown.
 2. When an IV pump was in use, turned it off, clamped the tubing, and removed the tubing from the pump. Unhooked the IV container from the pole and slid the tubing and IV container through the arm of the patient's gown. Rehung the IV container on the pole, then reinserted the tubing into the pump, unclamped it, and turned the pump on at the correct rate. Reestablished the appropriate flow rate if necessary.

Warmed the contents of a package of disposable cloths per the manufacturer's instructions for use. Used a clean cloth for each area of the body. Used caution around IV sites, dressings, and nonintact skin.

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Removed a single premoistened cloth and began by cleansing the face and neck.

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Folded the bath blanket or towel that was over the patient's chest down to the umbilicus. Obtained a clean cloth and cleansed the chest and abdomen using long, firm strokes.

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Covered the patient's chest and abdomen with the bath blanket or towel, leaving the arm on the near side exposed.

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Removed a clean cloth and cleansed the exposed arm and hand; cleansed axilla last; applied deodorant when desired.

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Raised the side rail, then moved to the opposite side of the bed and lowered the side rail.

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Using a clean cloth, cleansed the other arm and hand in the same manner.

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Helped the patient into a clean gown or pajama top; dressed the affected side first. When necessary, omitted this step until the bath was complete. Covered the patient with a clean bath blanket or towel; placed the soiled linen in a linen bag.

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Exposed the near leg, ensuring that the perineal area and the other leg remained draped. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed a clean cloth from the package and cleansed the exposed leg, using long, firm strokes from the ankle to the knee and then from the knee to the thigh. Assessed the leg for signs of DVT. ☐ ☐ ☐

Used a clean cloth to cleanse the foot; cleansed and filed the nails as needed. ☐ ☐ ☐

Used a clean dry towel to dry the toes and foot. ☐ ☐ ☐

Covered the cleansed leg and raised the side rail. ☐ ☐ ☐

Moved to the opposite side of the bed and lowered the side rail. ☐ ☐ ☐

Exposed the other leg and foot. Cleansed them with a clean cloth, provided nail care as needed, and dried the toes and foot. ☐ ☐ ☐

Covered the cleansed leg and foot. ☐ ☐ ☐

Provided perineal care. Removed a clean cloth from the package and cleansed the perineal area, or allowed the patient to cleanse the area if he or she was able. Used an extra pack of fresh disposable cloths or used washcloths with soap and water, and towels when needed for excessive soiling. ☐ ☐ ☐

1. For a male patient, cleansed around the penis. For a female patient, cleansed the outer and inner labia. See the video skills on performing male and female perineal care.
 2. Assisted the patient as needed into a side-lying position to cleanse the buttocks.
 3. Kept the patient draped by sliding the bath blanket or towel over the shoulders and thighs.
 4. When fecal material was present, enclosed the waste in a fold of underpad or toilet tissue. Disposed of the tissue or wipes in the appropriate waste container.
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Removed a clean cloth from the package and cleansed the patient's back using long, firm strokes. ☐ ☐ ☐

Assisted the patient into a comfortable position. ☐ ☐ ☐

When not done previously, assisted the patient as needed with donning a clean gown, pajamas, or other clothing as applicable. Dressed the affected side first. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised the side rail. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed gloves and performed hand hygiene.

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Gave a back rub when the patient desired; donned clean gloves if needed.

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Assisted the patient with grooming.

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Applied gloves and made the patient's bed.

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Removed soiled linen and placed it in the dirty linen bag. Did not allow linen to contact uniform.

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Cleaned and replaced bathing equipment.

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Returned the waste container and laundry hamper to their original locations.

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Removed gloves and performed hand hygiene.

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Checked the function and position of external devices.

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Replaced the call light, and neatly arranged personal possessions. Placed the bed in the locked, low position with an appropriate number of side rails raised. Made sure the patient was as comfortable as possible.

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Disposed of used supplies and equipment.

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Performed hand hygiene.

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Documented and reported the patient's response and expected or unexpected outcomes.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____